

LinkedIn in 2026: The Strategy Cheat Sheet



The algorithm rewards depth over frequency. One great post that sparks conversation outperforms five that don't.

15x

Comment vs. Like

15.6%

61+ sec Dwell Rate

1.2%

<3 sec Dwell Rate

5x

Personal vs. Page

~30%

Internal Penalty

THE SLOW BURN EFFECT

- Posts circulate for days or weeks when they spark threaded conversation. One strong post outperforms five mediocre ones.
- Team members comment over 2-3 days to extend reach. Don't pile on in the first 10 minutes.
- A 48-hour event recap often outperforms a rushed same-day post. Substance over speed.
- Track post lifespan (days still generating engagement) as a primary KPI.

THE REPOST DECISION

Comment (12+ words): 15x a like. Pushes post into your network. Default move.

Straight Repost: Best for the original creator. Outperforms repost-with-thoughts for their reach.

Repost + Thoughts (100+): Builds YOUR authority. 2-3x engagement for you. Original gets indirect exposure only.

Repost + Thoughts (<20): AVOID. Underperforms 3x. Hurts original by 12x vs straight repost.

PERSONAL PROFILE vs. COMPANY PAGE

Personal Profile (Primary Channel)

- Thought leadership, personal takes, solo video, contrarian insights
- Gets 5x more engagement. Generates threaded conversations that slow-burn for days.

Company Page (Supporting Channel)

- Announcements, member spotlights, clips with episode framing, educational content
- Weekly round-up: screenshot best team content, tag them, explain why it matters

Crossover: Company page comments on exec posts to expand reach without a repost

INTEREST CLUSTERS: 3 AUDIENCES FROM 1 EVENT

- Not a fixed list. Dynamically generated by the algorithm based on each user's engagement history. Your framing determines which cluster you land in.
- The words you use ARE the targeting. Name policies = policy people see it. Talk about hiring = HR people see it. Talk about deal structure = investors see it.
- Same event, 3 framings = 3 audiences. "Everyone repost the same thing" = same 500 people 3x.

EVENT-WEEK RULES

- One post per account per day, even during a 3-day conference.
- Stagger times across accounts (8 AM, 12 PM, 3 PM). Never same hour.
- Different angles on the same event. Photos with faces > venue shots. Tag everyone.

CONTENT SOURCES: WHAT WORKS

Podcast Clips: Front door to ecosystem. Guest sharing = new networks.

Long-Form Text: Highest slow burn. 200-400 words, short paragraphs.

Solo Video: Authority engine. Authentic > polished. 60-120 sec.

PDF Carousels: 2-3x more dwell time. High save rate. 3-8 frames. **Event**

Photos: Faces > venues. Tag everyone. 48-hr recap = best post. **Policy**

Updates: High engagement when opinionated. Not press-release.

Outside Links: Link penalty ~60%. Always use comment-link workaround.

Alternate reach-expanding (clips, event photos, tags) with depth-building (text, carousels, solo video) content.

Links go in first comment 60-90 min after publishing.

POSTING RHYTHM & PROTOCOL

Frequency

- Personal: 3-5x/week. Company: 3-4x/week. Max 1 post/day per account.
- 2+ posts/day = 40%+ median reach drop per post. Let slow burn work.

Before Posting

- 15-min warm-up: comment on 3-5 relevant industry posts to prime the algorithm.

After Posting

- First 15 min = highest impact. Golden Hour (60-90 min) = 70% of reach. Your team can manage this via Buffer.

DISTRIBUTING ANY CONTENT: THE 5-DAY RULE

Day 1: Founder/exec posts a personal take (text post). Link in comment.

Day 2: Company page posts the visual asset (clip, graphic, photo).

Day 3: Team member posts from a different angle or interest cluster.

Day 4: Partner, guest, or collaborator shares from their own profile.

Day 5: Quote graphic, carousel, or data card from the strongest insight.

Works for episodes, blog posts, events, solo videos, or any content worth more than one post. One asset = 5 days, zero duplication.

IDEA-TO-POST SYSTEM (15-20 MIN)

1. Find the Angle (2 min): What did I see this week that only someone in my position would notice? Would a stranger find it useful?

2. Write the Body (5-8 min): Start with the insight. 200-400 words. 1-2 sentence paragraphs. Every paragraph teaches, challenges, or gives language.

3. Write the Hook (3 min): First 2 lines before "See More." Use contradiction, specific number, direct accusation, stolen thought, or absurd reframe.

4. Add Visual + Publish (5 min): 1080x1350 image (scrappy > polished), or the clip itself with captions. 1-3 hashtags. Link in first comment 60-90 min later.

The formatting IS the readability strategy. Nobody reads a wall of text, but short paragraphs read like a scroll, not an essay.

STOP TRACKING:

Total likes | Follower count without quality | Impressions without engagement | Post frequency as success

START TRACKING:

Comment depth | Saves | Post lifespan (days active) | Target-title engagement | Inbound DMs